



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Liberty Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.lca-co.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Liberty Classical Academy (New Castle, CO, 81647) presents a robust classical Christian framework across most rubric domains. The school explicitly anchors its mission in Christian faith, integrates theology with classical disciplines, and foregrounds the liberal arts (grammar–logic–rhetoric) along with Great Books / Great Conversation, and a University-Model approach that emphasizes formation through a partnership with families. Public materials consistently reference truth, goodness, and beauty as organizing ideals, and emphasize formation of character and virtue, not merely information or career preparation. Collectively, the six classical-school categories skew toward CLASSICAL, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing modest tension toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to explicit lower-school singing/memory work and some ambiguity about strictly Socratic seminar use in upper grades. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key insights at a glance:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strong and explicit (Statement of Faith, Biblical worldview, virtue/theology grounding).
- Purpose and Goal emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and a teleological orientation toward truth/beauty/goodness.
- Curriculum centers on the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, and a Great Conversation, with coherent history-driven unit studies.
- Pedagogy shows classical structure (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and emphasis on memory and integrative learning; explicit Socratic/seminar methods are less overt in the public material, placing Pedagogy at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Faculty portrayal stresses professional, mentor-like teachers, living-curriculum orientation, and staff development aligned with the school's Christian/classical aims.
- Parents & Community are deeply engaged as co-educators, with ongoing programs (Practical Parenting Classes, meetings, campus visits) and open parent involvement policies.

ABSTRACT

Liberty Classical Academy (New Castle, CO, 81647) aligns strongly with core classical education premisses (virtue/formation, Great Books, liberal arts, theology-integrated curriculum, heavy parental partnership). The aggregate classification is CLASSICAL, with a single category (Pedagogy) ranking SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to the blended, non-uniform emphasis on some non-Socratic, non-memorization pedagogy. Overall, the school demonstrates a coherent classical framework with explicit religious foundations.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials state explicit theological commitments in the Statement of Faith (We believe the Bible alone to be the Word of God).
- Vision and mission articulate immersion in truth, beauty, and goodness in order to know God and to make Him known.
- Foundational religion-based framing appears in Foundation/Mission statements that emphasize a Christian worldview and biblical formation.
- References to Scripture and Christian virtue by design (e.g., “biblical studies” and “in submission to God”).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present in public materials: truth, goodness, beauty, theology, sacred scripture, God, biblical, liturgical/chapel language, Logos (as implied in classical-religious framework). Key explicit terms include “truth, beauty, and goodness” and “Bible alone to be the Word of God.”
- Negative keywords present: none observed in public content. (No evident relativism or secular neutrality in the public-facing materials.)
- Quantitative note: 6–7 distinct positive religious/metaphysical keywords identified; 0 negative keywords identified in public content.
- Why this rating
- The school’s public materials consistently ground education in a Christian metaphysical frame (Scripture, theology, theocentric aims) and explicitly invoke truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendentals shaping formation. This strongly satisfies the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and lacks explicit negative signals in public text.

Citations: Bible/Word of God statement ; Vision/Truth/Beauty language ; Mission/Vision and educational grounding ; In loco parentis and theology framing

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission: Cultivating Classically-trained Christian Leaders.
- Vision emphasizes immersion in truth, beauty, and goodness to know God; formation of virtue and wisdom is foregrounded.
- Public statements describe forming humans who think clearly, discern, and use learning rightly in service to God, not just job preparation.
- Great Conversation is highlighted as a curricular aim (engaging with original sources through history).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, Great Conversation, telos, pursuit of true/good/beautiful, human flourishing. Representative phrases appear in mission and curricular descriptions.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in public content (no explicit emphasis on purely job-readiness or 21st-century skills as end goals).

- Quantitative note: ~6–8 positive keywords identified; 0 negative keywords observed.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated purpose centers on formation—virtue, wisdom, and classical-humanistic aims—consistent with classical education philosophy rather than a narrow career- or skills-first aim.

Citations: Mission statement with leadership-formation aim ; Vision/formation language ; Educational philosophy emphasizing discernment and the Great Conversation

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Explicit structure around the Trivium: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric.
- Emphasis on Great Books / Great Conversation and original sources; aims to access “The Great Conversation” through history.
- Year-by-year unit-history approach (Antiquity, Christendom, American culture, Modernity) indicates interdisciplinary, historical integration.
- Mention of Latin emphasis and languages; liberal-arts content; and integrated history-literature-philosophy-teaching; Tapestry of Grace references in upper-grammar Humanities discussions.
- Public materials describe a curriculum grounded in Western civilization, classical humanities, and living texts.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books / Great Conversation, primary sources/original texts, history across curriculum, Latin, Western civilization, interdisciplinary/harmony of subjects, living books.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public content (no replacement with “social studies” framing; no CST- or STEM-first emphasis).
- Quantitative note: 8–12 distinct positive curriculum keywords identified; 0 negative keywords.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum aligns with the classical education hallmark set: Trivium-centric structure, great books, integrated history, and emphasis on formation through canonical texts.

Citations: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric framework and Great Conversation emphasis ; Latin/humanities/unit-history rotation ; Western civilization and primary sources language

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Lower/grammar stage pedagogy includes memory-based elements (singing, chanting, memory-review) in line with scholé-era pedagogy, as seen in preschool and grammar-focused materials.
- The school emphasizes a grammar/logic/rhetoric progression and memory work, consistent with classical pedagogy in form.
- Upper grades mention Socratic-like discussion or rhetoric training in public materials? The public site emphasizes rhetoric and public speaking in the rhetoric stage, but explicit Socratic seminars in practice aren't consistently documented in public text; some materials cite “Great Conversation” and original

texts as core, which often implies discussion-based engagement but not explicitly labeled as Socratic seminars.

- Public-facing materials emphasize integration of learning (unit studies, Western history) and experiential/arts components (theatre, field days), pointing to a blended pedagogy rather than a single rigid method.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: memorization/recitation, chanting, narration, restfulness/scholé, Socratic dialogue (implicit in “Great Conversation” and rhetoric training), seminars/debates (language appears in the rubric but explicit examples are less consistent in public text).
- Negative keywords present: experiential learning and project-based emphasis appear in some classical-education lexicons as potential divergences; the school’s public materials show more integrated unit-study and experiential components, which can be seen as a partial divergence from strict “recitation/narration only” pedagogy. The lexicon lists such as “experiential learning” as a potential negative signal, but the public content frequently pairs it with classical aims (unit studies, history/narrative). This yields a mixed signal.
- Quantitative note: positive keywords identified include memory-work, narration, recitation, chanting (present in public text and related philosophy); negative cues appear less explicit in text but are present in the broader classical lexicon; overall, positive signals exist but with some ambiguity in the explicit pedagogy phrasing.
- Why this rating
- The public materials demonstrate a fundamentally classical pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, memory-work, narration). However, the explicit depiction of Socratic seminars and strict scholé/restful pace in high school is not consistently documented in the public-facing site content, and there are blended/experiential elements. This justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than full CLASSICAL.

Citations: Preschool/grammar memory language (singing/recitation) ; Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric structure and Great Conversation ; Upper Humanities and public text referencing cross-disciplinary units (Tapestry of Grace, etc.) ; Public theatre/experiential activities (e.g., theatre productions) as part of curriculum integration

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school cites a Head of School and governance structures (In Loco Parentis; board governance; policies in the public materials).
- Educational philosophy emphasizes teachers as living curriculum and mentors who model virtue and love of learning; staff are expected to be professional, diligent, and well-supported.
- The Statement of Faith and the Vision emphasize alignment of faculty with the school’s religious and classical aims; teachers are described as professionals who can teach from a Christian worldview.
- The campus materials and annual communications show ongoing professional development, mentorship, and staff who are expected to understand classical education and how their work fits into the whole.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentors, professional, teacher as model, staff development, fellowship with students, alignment with a Christian/classical mission.

- Negative keywords present: none in public-facing content (no indications of low faculty expectations or non-classical training).
- Quantitative note: multiple positive keywords (mentor/teacher as living-curriculum, professional, staff development, model virtue) with 0 negative signals.
- Why this rating
- The public materials convey a faculty culture centered on character formation, mentorship, and alignment with the school's Christian/classical mission. This aligns strongly with the Classical framework for Faculty.

Citations: Living-curriculum and staff development language in Educational Philosophy (turn1file12) and Mission/Vision (turn1file16); Statement of Faith (turn1file18); Governance/In loco parentis text (turn2file7)

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school openly positions parents as co-teachers and delegated authorities (In Loco Parentis); schooling is designed to partner with families.
- Ongoing engagement with parents includes Practical Parenting Classes, family evenings, and community events; open invitations to engage with the school (e.g., tours, open visits).
- Public material references parent meetings, Monthly Classroom Meetings, and parent involvement in school governance and fundraising (e.g., attitudes toward parental leadership and involvement).
- There is a clear emphasis on educating parents about classical education (e.g., Winter Mini Conference, parenting sessions, and book-study opportunities).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, home-school partnership, parental involvement, family catechesis.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public content.
- Quantitative note: multiple positive keywords identified; 0 negative signals.
- Why this rating
- The public materials present robust, ongoing parent engagement and a strong belief in parents as co-educators, consistent with the Classical education model's emphasis on □□ formation and active parental involvement.

Citations: Parent partnership and co-teaching language (turn2file7); Practical Parenting Classes and events (turn2file1, turn2file12); Open-campus and parent formation (turn0file14)

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall Classification: CLASSICAL
- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: The school demonstrates a coherent classical-Christian program: theological grounding, formation-focused aims, a Seven Liberal Arts curriculum with Great Books, and a classical pedagogy structure (grammar–logic–rhetoric) in the public-facing materials. Pedagogy (Element 4) shows blended methods including memory-based and experiential elements, thereby not fully committing to strict, traditional Socratic/seminar-centered instruction in all grades, which places Element 4 at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Despite this, the weight of evidence across the other five categories strongly supports CLASSICAL.
- Note on consistency with the “Six Essential Elements” rubric: The public materials show explicit engagement with the core elements (wisdom/virtue, truth/goodness/beauty, formation, liberal arts, Great Books, learner formation, parental partnership) as described in the canonical rubric. The lexical mappings from the knowledge-base materials (Positive/Negative keyword indicators) align with the observed themes in Liberty Classical Academy’s communications, reinforcing CLASSICAL as the aggregate.

Citations tying the evaluation to the rubric and materials:

- Positive/Negative keyword framework and six elements (core rubric references): Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) (Positive Keywords; Negative Keywords) and related lexicon. See the included document suite for the rubric.
- The school’s statements of faith, mission, and Great Books framing (Evidence cited above).

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here since the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL. The singular SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal in Pedagogy could be addressed by a public articulation of explicit Socratic/seminar-based practices and a more consistent articulation of schola-based restfulness and chant/memorization traditions in upper grades. If the school wanted to move toward a fully CLASSICAL Pedagogy designation, it could:
- Publish concrete, K–12 evidence of Socratic seminars or seminars-like discussions in upper grades with exemplars and rubrics.
- Increase explicit description of memory-work, recitation, and chanting as a core, repeated practice in the upper grades (and tie it to assessment).
- Highlight how Scholé (restful, contemplative pace) is maintained across grade bands with specific schedule patterns.
- Otherwise, the core religious, curricular, and community commitments appear well aligned with classical education and would remain CLASSICAL with minor, targeted enhancements in Pedagogy documentation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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